ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 2

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 3 hours**

NC(V) fundamental subject, Level 2. Section A: Comprehension (30) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context (25) · Section D: Writing (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 2. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of FOUR sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (30), SECTION B: Summary (10), SECTION C: Language in context (25) and SECTION D: Writing (35).
2. Answer ALL the questions in Sections A, B and C. In Section D, answer ONE question from Question 4 and ONE question from Question 5.
3. Read all the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where asked.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

My First Week as an Apprentice

1 When I arrived at Mokoena Electrical on my first Monday, I was sure I already knew everything. After all, I had passed my college practicals with high marks. Mr Mokoena, the owner, looked at my new overalls and smiled. "Today you will not touch a single wire," he said. "Today you will watch and learn."

2 I was disappointed. I wanted to show him what I could do. Instead, I followed Sizwe, a qualified electrician with fifteen years of experience, from one job to the next. At the first house, a family had no power in their kitchen. Before Sizwe even opened the distribution board, he switched off the main switch, locked it and hung a sign on it that read "DO NOT SWITCH ON – PERSON WORKING". Then he tested the circuit with a voltage tester, even though the switch was off.

3 "Why do you test it if you switched it off?" I asked. Sizwe looked at me seriously. "Because the day you trust a switch is the day you get hurt. A colleague of mine once worked on a circuit that someone else had labelled wrongly. He was lucky to survive."

4 By Wednesday I had learnt more than in a whole term of theory. I learnt how to speak politely to customers, how to explain a problem without using difficult technical words, and how to write a clear job card so that the office could invoice the customer correctly. I also learnt that being on time is not optional. When I arrived ten minutes late on Thursday because I had missed my taxi, Mr Mokoena did not shout. He simply said, "The customer was waiting. Our name is our reputation."

5 On Friday, Sizwe finally handed me a screwdriver. "Show me how you will replace this socket outlet," he said. I explained every step before I started, and he nodded. When I had finished, he tested my work and said, "Good. Now you are starting to become an electrician."

6 That evening I realised that my qualification had opened the door, but that experience, safety and respect would decide how far I would go.

1.1	Where did the writer start working?	(1)
1.2	Why was the writer sure that he "already knew everything" (paragraph 1)?	(1)
1.3	How did the writer feel when Mr Mokoena told him not to touch any wires? Quote ONE word to support your answer.	(2)
1.4	Name THREE safety steps Sizwe took before working on the distribution board (paragraph 2).	(3)
1.5	Explain in your own words why Sizwe tested the circuit even though the switch was off.	(2)
1.6	What happened to Sizwe's colleague?	(2)
1.7	Name THREE skills, other than technical skills, that the writer learnt by Wednesday.	(3)
1.8	Why is it important to write a clear job card?	(2)
1.9	What does Mr Mokoena mean when he says, "Our name is our reputation"?	(2)
1.10	How did Mr Mokoena react when the writer was late? What does this show about his character?	(3)
1.11	Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter. The word "optional" (paragraph 4) means: A compulsory B something you may choose to do or not C dangerous D difficult	(1)
1.12	Why did the writer explain every step before replacing the socket outlet?	(2)
1.13	Is the following statement TRUE or FALSE? Quote a phrase to support your answer. *Sizwe was impressed with the writer's work on Friday.*	(2)
1.14	Explain the writer's realisation in paragraph 6 in your own words.	(2)
1.15	Would you like to work for Mr Mokoena? Give TWO reasons for your answer.	(2)

[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Read the notice below. In point form, list SEVEN rules for working safely in the college workshop.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be longer than 70 words. Write the number of words at the end.

WORKSHOP SAFETY – READ BEFORE YOU ENTER

Welcome to the electrical workshop. Our aim is that every student goes home safely every day. You must wear your overalls and safety boots at all times when you are in the workshop. Rings, watches and chains conduct

electricity, so remove them before you start working. Never work on a live circuit; always switch off and test first. Check your tools before you use them, and report any tool with damaged insulation to the lecturer immediately. Keep your workbench clean, because loose wire off-cuts can cause injuries. Food and drinks are not allowed near the equipment. Finally, if there is an accident, no matter how small, report it to the lecturer at once so that it can be recorded.

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

Read the sentences below, based on the text in Question 1, and answer the questions.

3.1 Rewrite the sentence in the passive voice: *Sizwe tested the circuit.* (2)

3.2 Rewrite in reported (indirect) speech: *"Today you will not touch a single wire," he said.* (3)

3.3 Rewrite in the future tense: *I followed Sizwe from one job to the next.* (1)

3.4 Give the plural of: (a) electrician (b) family (c) switch (3)

3.5 Give the opposite (antonym) of: (a) qualified (b) polite (2)

3.6 Form a noun from the verb "explain". (1)

3.7 Combine the two sentences into one using "because": *The writer was late. He missed his taxi.* (1)

3.8 Correct the error in each sentence: (a) *Sizwe have fifteen years of experience.* (b) *The customers was waiting.* (2)

3.9 Identify the part of speech of the underlined word: *He spoke <u>seriously</u>.* (1)

3.10 Punctuate the following sentence correctly: *where is the voltage tester asked the apprentice* (3)

3.11 Choose the correct word in brackets: (a) *The tools are over (their / there / they're).* (b) *Please (accept / except) my apology.* (2)

3.12 Write ONE sentence in which you use the abbreviation "e.g." correctly. (1)

3.13 Explain the meaning of the idiom: *to learn the ropes*. (2)

3.14 Rewrite the sentence starting with "Neither …": *The writer did not touch a wire, and Sizwe did not let him.* (1)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING

QUESTION 4: ESSAY

Write an essay of 200–250 words on ONE of the following topics. Give your essay a title.

4.1 The day I learnt an important lesson at work or at college [20]

4.2 Why safety rules save lives [20]

4.3 My dream job and how I plan to get it [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5: TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

Choose ONE of the following. Write 100–120 words. Use the correct format.

5.1 **Formal letter.** Write a letter to Mr Mokoena of Mokoena Electrical, 14 Church Street, Polokwane, applying for an apprenticeship. Mention your qualification and why you want to work for the company. [15]

5.2 **E-mail.** You arrived late at work because of a taxi strike. Write an e-mail to your supervisor to apologise and explain what you will do to prevent it from happening again. [15]

5.3 **Memorandum.** You are the student representative. Write a memo to all Level 2 students about the new workshop safety rules. [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF QUESTION PAPER